

Week 10 Lit Example Reader

JULIUS CAESAR: PROOF THAT MISSES THE POINT

Purpose: Julius Caesar passages for Week 10: test whether a speech proves the exact point at issue or only a nearby claim.

What to watch for: Strong evidence, moving examples, and public pressure that may answer a different question from the one under debate.

Before the Passages: The Week 10 Logic Tool

- **Point at issue:** the exact question the speaker must answer.
- **Nearby claim:** something related and maybe true, but not the same as the conclusion.
- **Repair:** add evidence that answers the issue, or narrow the conclusion to match what was actually proved.

Passage 1: Act 3, Scene 2 — Brutus Explains the Killing

Context: Brutus must justify Caesar's assassination to the Roman people. Watch what he proves, and what still needs proof.

Brutus. Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more.
Had you rather Caesar were living and die all slaves, than that Caesar
were dead, to live all free men? As Caesar loved me, I weep for him;
as he was fortunate, I rejoice at it; as he was valiant, I honour him:
but, as he was ambitious, I slew him. There is tears for his love; joy
for his fortune; honour for his valour; and death for his ambition.
Who is here so base that would be a bondman? If any, speak; for him
have I offended.

Reader Notes

This is your assisted example. Brutus gives the crowd a clear public question: was Caesar's death justified? He offers a nearby claim: Caesar was ambitious, and ambition threatens liberty. Week 10 asks whether the evidence proves the exact conclusion—that killing Caesar was necessary and just—or whether it proves only a related concern about ambition and freedom. Notice the slave/free alternative: it can make the issue feel settled before all parts of the case have been proved.

Reading task: Underline Brutus's main conclusion. Box the word *ambitious*. In the margin, write the exact point at issue: what must Brutus prove to justify the killing?

Passage 2: Act 3, Scene 2 — Antony Answers

Context: Antony replies after Brutus. Watch whether Antony proves the conspirators wrong, proves Caesar was not ambitious, or proves a nearby emotional point.

Antony. He hath brought many captives home to Rome
Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill:
Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?
When that the poor have cried, Caesar hath wept:
Ambition should be made of sterner stuff:
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;
And Brutus is an honourable man.
You all did see that on the Lupercal
I thrice presented him a kingly crown,
Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition?

Reader Notes

This passage shifts more work to you. Antony gives evidence that may answer part of Brutus's charge: ransom money for Rome, pity for the poor, and refusing a crown. Mark what each piece of evidence actually proves. Then decide what larger conclusion the crowd may be moving toward, and whether Antony's proof fully reaches it.

Reading task: Number Antony's three pieces of evidence. Next to each, write the smaller claim it supports. Save the final prompt-match judgment for the worksheet.

How to Use These Passages on the Worksheet

Do not summarize the funeral speeches. Use Week 10's question: what exact point is at issue, and does the offered proof match it?